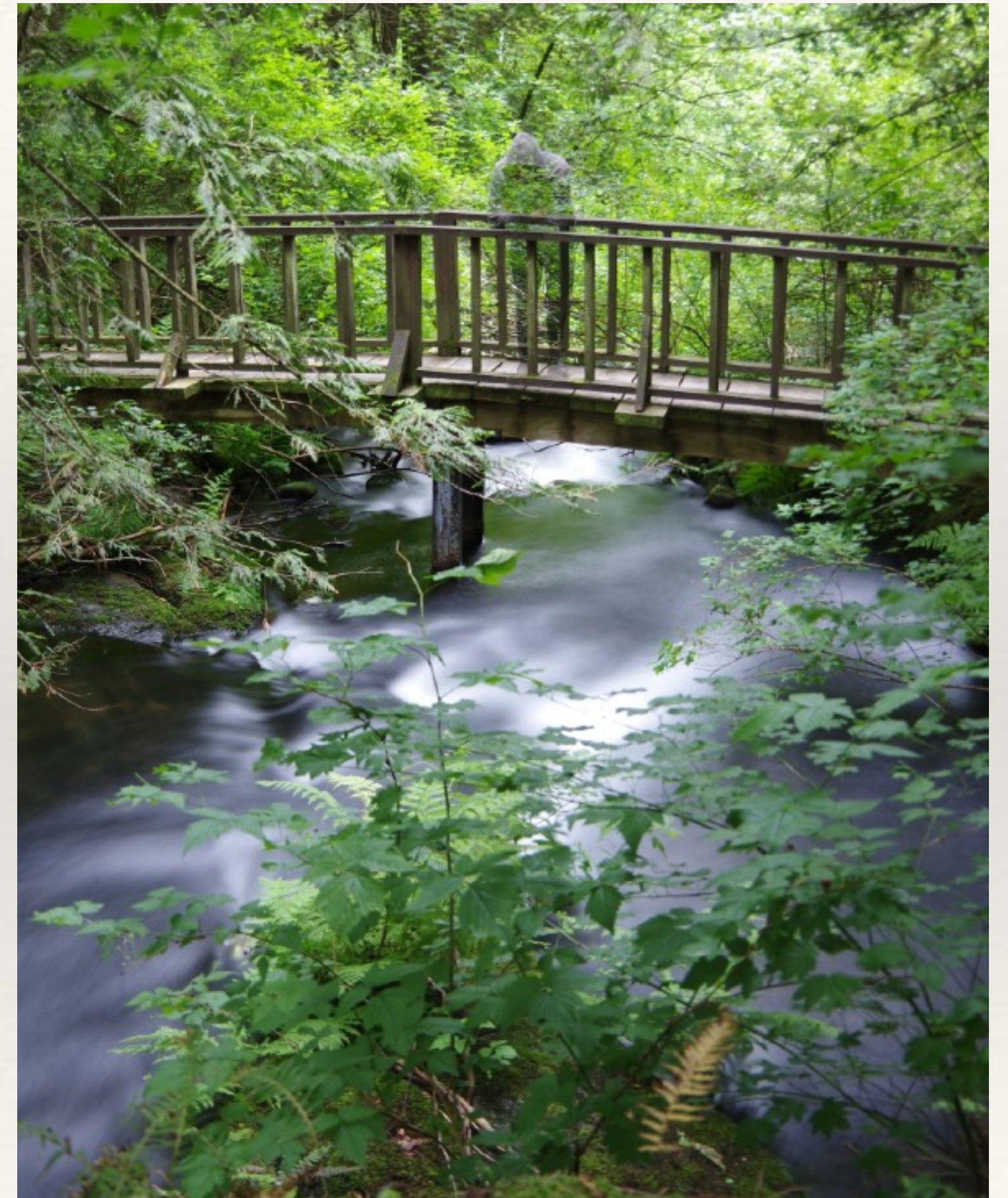

Moonset

The moon, once blue, has faded from view
Yet traces of you remain in the morning dew
Time withdrew; something remained true

Familiar scents drift my way, collapsing years into yesterday
Mistaking warmth for home, strangers for remedies
Seeking relief from grief, finding only make-belief

For touch may soothe the blues, but cannot replace what we lose
Though passions burn bright, connections outlast the night
Pleasure may ease desire, yet never kindle the same fire



Venus & Saturn

Two lights that only met in passing sight
With timing and distance aligned at night

On the Summer Solstice, we began
In an ordinary aisle, under fluorescent plan
Where nothing celestial was meant to land

Conversation flowing, unclaimed and free
I mistook proximity for clarity
And called it more than it could be

Your presence rearranged the air
Not as promise, but as flare
A brightness I began to wear

When you smiled, I filled in the rest
Wrote constellations across your chest
And called the guesswork something blessed

For Venus and Saturn do not touch
They only appear to, just enough

